

The Explanation Ledger

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I made InvestmentRegulation.ca while studying for a Canadian investment-industry exam. The official material was accurate, but hard to enter as a beginner. AI could explain a rule in simpler words. It could also give me a confident answer that was completely wrong.

That experience led to the Explanation Ledger, a classroom method where important AI answers have to show where they came from. For each claim, a student records the claim, the source, whether the source actually supports it, and what changed after checking.

How the class would work

Each lesson starts with a short problem. A student makes an initial choice and records how confident they are before using AI.

The student can then ask AI to simplify the source, give an example, challenge the answer, or explain why another choice could seem reasonable. The AI must link to the exact passage behind an important claim. If it cannot find support, it has to say so plainly.

Students then trade ledgers with a classmate and look for one weak point. The source may be reliable but unrelated to the claim. A quotation may lose its meaning when taken out of context. The AI may have skipped an exception. The goal is to improve the explanation, not to embarrass the other student.

The teacher chooses a few disputed claims for the class to discuss. At the end, students answer the original problem again and explain why they kept or changed their answer. Changing your mind for a good reason counts as progress.

AI would be useful here because it is fast and patient. It can explain one rule in several ways, create more practice, and change one fact at a time in a scenario. It can also point out where a learner's explanation differs from the source. The ledger makes that help reviewable instead of letting it disappear inside a chat.

What I would keep human

I would refuse to let AI decide that someone is ready to make important decisions for another person.

This matters in finance, health, law, safety, and any field where a learner's next decision can affect someone else. A quiz score cannot show everything. A person must be able to notice confusion, explain a choice, admit uncertainty, and know when to ask for help.

AI can spot patterns in practice answers and recommend another lesson. Final readiness would still require a short conversation with a teacher, mentor, or qualified professional. The learner would explain a decision and walk through the evidence. The reviewer would record the reason for the decision so the learner could understand and challenge it.

Keeping this decision human changes the rest of the design. The system has to preserve evidence that a person can review. It cannot hide behind a score.

What could go wrong

A citation can look convincing without supporting the answer. That is why the ledger shows the exact passage and asks the learner to decide whether it supports, complicates, or contradicts the claim.

The ledger could also become a record used against students. The learner should own it, be able to export or delete it, and share only what a lesson requires. Teachers need to see learning problems, not a secret personality score.

Access matters too. The basic method should work on a phone or a printed sheet. AI can improve the activity when it is available, but a learner should not need an expensive device or constant internet access to take part.

Starting small

I would test the first version inside InvestmentRegulation.ca. I would choose a small group of difficult rules and add source cards, confidence checks, a challenge button, and a short explain-back prompt.

The test would ask practical questions. Did learners open the source? Could they explain why an answer changed? Did they catch an unsupported claim? Did the extra checking help without making the lesson so slow that beginners gave up?

I would publish the code, results, and problems with the existing open-source project. Other schools or training programs could reuse the method without committing to one AI company.

The classroom I want makes difficult material easier to enter while keeping the reasoning visible. AI can provide explanations, examples, and practice. Students and teachers remain responsible for checking important claims and deciding when someone is ready to use what they learned.